

Who is to Blame?

A discourse analytic comparison of the news reports on the killing of George Floyd in Mainland China and Taiwan

Chenyang Lin

University of California at Los Angeles

Critical discourse analysis (CDA) has been broadly applied to understand the social implications of discourse, yet few studies have compared different forms of discourse in Chinese media, especially on the topic of race. Referencing the CDA framework, this study compares two sample news items from Mainland China and Taiwan about the killing of George Floyd and the associated social movements, analyzing their presentational forms, sourcing patterns, headlines, lexical and syntactic choices. A racial analysis is also conducted to better comprehend how racism is constructed and potentially reproduced in Chinese media. The results suggest that the two media sources bifurcate in reporting styles – due to respective journalistic environments and regulations – and their attitudes towards the cause of the reported event. However, they both explicitly identify the issue of racism in the US. This study applies CDA in a non-US context to uncover the reporting styles and racial connotations in Chinese news discourse from Mainland China and Taiwan, identifying future directions for racial discourse analysis in Chinese media.

Keywords: critical discourse analysis (CDA), television news, presentational forms, headlines and sub-headlines, lexical choices, syntactic choices, racial

关键词：批判性话语分析、电视新闻、表现形式、标题及副标题、词汇选择、句法选择、种族

1. Introduction

On May 25, 2020, George Floyd, a 46-year-old African American male from Minneapolis, was killed during a police arrest for suspected use of counterfeit

currency. The murder of George Floyd was universally televised during the COVID-19 pandemic. In a recorded video of the arrest, Floyd begged for his life while a white police officer knelt on his neck for 8 minutes and 46 seconds until he suffocated to death. He repeatedly said, 'I can't breathe,' which "became a familiar refrain globally," (Oriola and Knight 2020). The killing of George Floyd triggered protests in cities across the United States and internationally. The resulting social movements were also widely reported on by different types of media, including television. The event reflects the greater issue of racial discrimination and anti-Black sentiment in American society. The incident was selected for comparison in this study not only because of its widespread influence and significance but also because the incident was covered as foreign news around the same time by both sources examined. The scrutiny into news reports from media in Mainland China and Taiwan provides insights into the distinctions between the news-makers' reporting styles in foreign coverage as well as their attitudes towards the reported event per se and the corresponding socio-political context. Such findings may also reflect aspects of the power relationships between Mainland China, Taiwan, and the U.S. An analysis of foreign news coverage would differ from one of domestic coverage due to factors such as national interests and international relationships. While previous studies have comparatively investigated international news coverage from different countries (Archetti 2010), few have addressed discourse about race in foreign coverage. No previous studies were identified that addressed coverage of race in Chinese-language international news; therefore, the present study is the first step towards understanding how race is constructed in this genre. The news items serve as clear examples of the type of reports in which racial discourse could be analyzed in news media outside of the U.S., leading to a better understanding of how such reports could contribute to the discursive reproduction of racism.

Before getting into the analysis of the news reports targeting the killing of George Floyd, it is also critical to discuss the television news industry in general and the media environments in Mainland China and Taiwan. News broadcasting has matured as the predominant platform for journalism in recent decades and has largely displaced printed news (Sarrina 2001, Montgomery 2007). Television news can broadcast multifold facets of the same event, which may be presented in varying tones, styles, and stances resulting from the characteristics of the channels or stations, the media systems, and the socio-political circumstances. In Mainland China, both political interests and economic growth have been key in shaping news media, with the latter providing relative financial independence but not complete journalistic freedom from the former (Winfield and Peng 2005). The media system in Mainland China "is moving from totalitarianism to market authoritarianism," with media "representing their own economic interests" while

“performing the public functions imposed by the state” simultaneously (Winfield and Peng 2005). News media in Taiwan were once under strict control of the army, with television news highly regulated to bolster the government. After the lifting of martial law and the legalization of cable television in 1993, the governmental regulations were overturned, granting much more freedom to journalists and creating greater competitions among different forms of news media and between news providers (Sarrina 2001). Considering these differences between the media systems in Mainland China and Taiwan regarding their associated market environments and the amount of governmental regulations, it would be worthwhile to compare the strategies in discourse presentation and how they fit in with their respective situational and socio-cultural contexts.

News media have been extensively studied in the past using the framework of critical discourse analysis (CDA). CDA is an interdisciplinary method for assessing discourse within the context of viewing language as a social practice that both constructs and is informed by social reality (Van Dijk 1993). Previous investigations into CDA have analyzed discourse at the micro, meso, and macro levels. At the micro-level, linguistic characteristics of the text, such as lexical choices and syntactic structures, are analyzed for implied metaphors and persuasive devices (Fowler et al. 1979, Fowler 1991, Kress and Hodge 1979). The meso-level assesses the production and consumption aspects of discourse, such as the intended audience, and evaluates the interpretations of the discursive events. Macro-level assessment places discursive events within larger situational and socio-cultural contexts, taking their social implications into account (Fairclough 1992, Fairclough 1995, Van Dijk 1993). CDA originates from critical linguistics, which – in a socially directed manner – examines discourse in terms of its ideologies and depictions of society (Liu and Guo 2016). Critical linguistics claims that discourse is not only the product of social context but also a contributing factor to the construction of social reality (Fowler et al. 1979, Kress and Hodge 1979, Fairclough 1992). Therefore, studying the structures and strategies in discourse based on the corresponding social context would lead to a better understanding of the social meanings and mental models behind (Teo, 2000). Specifically for broadcasting news, Montgomery (2007, 20) suggests that it should be analyzed beyond the scripts as a “social interaction.” Bell (1991) also proposes three components for the analysis of a news story: abstract, attribution, and the story itself. A full understanding of the conveyed messages can be achieved by integrating these elements with the words and grammatical structures used within them. Considering all these components, a study of broadcasting news should not only include linguistic representations but also provide the “description, interpretation and explanation of various discourse acts, structures and practices” (Fairclough 1992, Feng 2013).

While discourse serves as “a social practice for racism,” it is also the “main source for people’s racist beliefs,” so studying it could deepen our understanding of both the “social and cognitive dimensions of racism” (Van Dijk 2000). Alim, Reyes, and Kroskrity (2020) argue that, rather than a static category, race is a dynamic social phenomenon that both stems from and interacts with language and discourse. While progress has been observed in recent decades in addressing racial disparities in the US, studies have shown that racial inequalities still exist in multiple social domains – including housing, education, and employment, etc. (Pager and Shepherd 2008). However, racial discrimination has now transformed to be less identifiable and more covert, into what is known as the “new racism” (Barker 1981). In the book “Racism without racists,” Eduardo Bonilla-Silva (2006) first proposes the concept of “colorblind racism,” which refers to a contemporary implicit manifestation of racism prevailing in public and social discourses. It is often utilized as a strategy for dismissing the issue of racism in support of a racialized stratification system that white people could benefit from (Bonilla-Silva 2006). Rather than deviating from race to “avoid reproducing racism,” scholarship in the sphere of racial discourse within non-US contexts is needed in that it offers a systematic understanding of the different attitudes towards racism through analyzing the discourse outcomes (Alim, Reyes, and Kroskrity 2020). Van Dijk (1993) demonstrates that discourse analysis could be conducted through the lens of racism by looking at the differences in surface and underlying structures that imply racial inequalities and dominance relationships.

Previous studies in journalism using CDA have largely focused on news media in English and other languages besides Chinese (Bednarek and Caple 2014, Kim 2014, Eberl et al. 2018), and have primarily examined discourse within the western media system. Even among studies investigating Chinese media, the majority have only investigated traditional press media rather than television news broadcasts (Fang 1994, Fang 2001, Yin 2006). To the author’s knowledge, much less research has been conducted specifically regarding racial discourse analysis in Chinese contexts, not to mention in Chinese media. Cheng (2011) identifies racism as mutually reinforced with Chinese nationalism, arguing that, without public awareness, racial discourse significantly shapes nationalism in Chinese society. Further investigation is needed to better understand how racial discourse in media is informed by and influence the social perception of race and racism among Chinese population.

The present study will analyze two television news reports from media in Mainland China and Taiwan regarding the killing of George Floyd and the associated social movements. The CDA paradigm is applied to better understand the socio-political context, ideology, and power relationships involved in the news items. Through the analysis of the presentational forms, sourcing patterns, head-

lines, lexical and syntactic choices, as well as reporting styles, it is possible to interpret the social implications constructed by the news discourse, the news-makers' intentions behind the reporting, and how the differences in discourse divergently shape the audience's perception of the reported event. This study contributes to the field of critical discourse analysis by using the framework to analyze broadcasting news media in Chinese and exploring the differences in how the new providers approach the reported event. The discrepancies may also imply the media-audience relationships, media systems, and governmental regulations in Mainland China and Taiwan. Additionally, the study provides a new perspective on racial discourse in Chinese media, with an analysis of how the concepts of race and racism are constructed in the news discourses. Such an analysis has rarely been done in the past and would thus open a direction for future research in Chinese discourse analysis.

2. Data and methodology

This case study investigates two broadcasting news clips on the report of the killing of George Floyd and the associated social movements. One was reported on May 30, 2020, by Dragon Television (东方卫视, *Dōngfāng Wèishi*) in Mainland China (看看新闻Knews综合 2020); the other was reported on May 29, 2020, by SET iNews (三立新聞台, *Sānlì Xīnwén Tái*) in Taiwan (三立iNews 2020). The two news clips were selected because both Dragon TV and SET iNews are among the well-recognized news media in their respective areas. Dragon TV is a provincial satellite TV channel owned by Radio and Television Station of Shanghai (RTS), which represents one of the large-scale state-owned media in Mainland China and is entirely or partially funded by the Chinese government. Therefore, Dragon TV may, to some degree, serve as a political voice and represent the stance of the Chinese government. SET iNews is a 24-hour news channel owned by Sanlih E-Television, known for leaning towards the Pan-Green Coalition and for its progressive ideologies. The Pan-Green Coalition favors Taiwanization over Chinese reunification while upholding the ideologies of social liberalism, progressivism, left-wing populism, and constitutionalism. Therefore, news reports in SET iNews may more or less reflect such political stance and ideologies. The two media formulate somewhat opposite political attitudes, which should also be considered in the analysis. As previously mentioned, media in Mainland China are, to various extents, regulated by the Chinese government and thus are primarily consistent in terms of voice representation. On the other hand, the journalistic freedom in Taiwan allows the media to have a spectrum of political tendencies with different audience preferences (Chiang and Shih 2017). Thus no one TV channel

alone could fully represent the Taiwanese media environment altogether. However, as SET iNews is among the most popular and well-known news media platforms, its analysis, especially those regarding international news, could still imply the general reporting styles of Taiwanese media and the socio-political context and media environment in Taiwan.

As the incident of George Floyd’s death and its relevant social events kept evolving in a dramatic manner, the timeliness of the news reports was determined to be an important factor to consider in order to select clips for comparison. The two clips were posted shortly after one another (May 29 and May 30), around ten days after George Floyd’s death, which allows them to be analyzed without having to consider the difference in reported time frames.

The study covers the following sections: comparison of the types and distributions of presentational forms in the news items; comparison of news sources in the two news items; comparison of the headlines, sub-headlines, as well as styles in the news items; and finally, a comparative racial analysis of the lexical and syntactic choices in the news items.

3. **Analysis**

3.1 **Presentational Elements in News**

According to Montgomery (2007), a news item can be divided into a news kernel and a news subsidiary. While the former concerns the main point to be covered, the latter is the detailed content of the report which supports the news kernel. News subsidiaries can be further divided into news reports, live interviews, and closing presentations, though closing presentations do not occur in every news item (see Figure 1).

News item	
News presentation	(+ News subsidiary)
News kernel	(+ News reports) (+ Live interviews) (+ Closing presentation)

Figure 1. The discourse structure of news items. Source: Montgomery (2007, p. 40).

Drawing upon the criteria established by Chandler (2007), Feng (2016) defines the categories of presentational forms as the production formats in television news. These formats consist of “directness” (i.e., face-to-face address with

direct gaze versus third-person narration), “formality” (i.e., public speech versus daily conversation), and “point of view” (i.e., first-person versus third-person narration). Different combinations of production formats are used to output information to and to establish a desired relationship with the intended audience. Compared to the presentational forms that Feng (2016) defines, the two selected news clips lack stand-uppers, live two-ways, and interview fragments. This might be because the two news clips are only parts of the larger news programs which last longer and thus are more inclusive of presentational forms. Feng (2016) distinguishes interview fragments from sound-bites in that the former concerns an interview while the latter concerns a monologic talk. However, it might be hard to make such a distinction to some news presentations, such as the ones selected for this study, as one couldn’t easily tell if they are excerpts from interviews or monologic talks. Therefore, the categories defined by Feng (2016) are adapted for the purpose of this paper as follows:

1. *On-camera address*: the news presenter speaks directly to the camera so the audience can see them directly on the screen.
2. *Off-camera presentation (or voice-over)*: the news presenter reports the news in the third person. Instead of speaking directly to the camera, the presenter presents his or her voice over the news footage.
3. *Sound-bite*: a fragment of a talk from a news source addressed directly to the camera.
4. *Sign-off*: the closing of a news item with the reporter’s information, the institution’s information, and the location of the report.

Different news programs have their own preferences for presentational forms, which play an essential role not only in structuring news items but in guiding the audience’s interpretation of the reported incidents. The following section will use these categories to analyze the selected news items.

3.2 Presentational structure of the Sample News Items

3.2.1 SET iNews

The entire news video clip features a blue theme color and has a total duration of 1 minute and 40 seconds. It begins with an audiovisual sign-in with the logo of SET iNews appearing in the middle of a blue background (see Figure 2). The bright visual and upbeat soundtrack work together to create a friendly tone while presenting a certain level of professionalism and authority simultaneously. After the audiovisual sign-in comes the news item. The presentational structure of the news item provided by the official clip of SET iNews excludes a news kernel,

which is conventionally brought up by studio-based presentations with either on-camera addresses or voice-overs (Feng 2016). The discourse starts with a field-based sound-bite of people shouting and visuals of buildings burning red, with the headline of the news item presented in the footage (see Figure 3). The rest of the news subsidiary progresses with studio-based voice-overs and sound-bites and ends with a brief sign-off remark (see Table 1).



Figure 2. The logo of SET iNews in the audiovisual sign-in, SET iNews



Figure 3. Visuals of buildings burning red with the headline presented at the bottom of the frame, SET iNews

3.2.2 *Dragon Television*

The news item from Dragon Television features a red theme color and has a total duration of 2 minutes and 1 second, 21 seconds longer than the one from SET News. It starts with a news kernel realized by a studio-based on-camera address

presented by a news anchor with an institutional voice. A medium close-up shot is used to feature the presenter at the center of the screen while she delivers the news kernel looking directly into the camera (see Figure 4). The rest of the news subsidiary consists of studio-based voice-overs and field-based sound-bites. The news item lacks a closing remark but rather ends with a field-based sound-bite.



Figure 4. Presenter directly addressing the news kernel with a medium close-up shot, Dragon TV

Based on the categories adapted from Feng (2016), I identified the presentational elements as well as their orders and respective durations for the two news items selected, as shown in Tables 1 and 2, and compared the percentages of the total times on each form presented, as shown in Tables 3 and 4.

Table 1. The durations of presentational elements in the news item from set news

Starting and ending time	Presentational element	Time length	Percentage of total time (100'')
00:05-00:12	(News subsidiary) studio-based voice-over	7''	7%
00:12-00:18	(News subsidiary) field-based sound-bite	6''	6%
00:19-00:27	(News subsidiary) studio-based voice-over	8''	8%
00:27-00:36	(News subsidiary) field-based sound-bite	9''	9%
00:36-01:05	(News subsidiary) studio-based voice-over	29''	29%
01:05-01:17	(News subsidiary) field-based sound-bite	12''	12%
01:17-01:38	(News subsidiary) studio-based voice-over	21''	21%
01:38-01:40	(News subsidiary) studio-based sign-off	2''	2%

Table 2. The durations of presentational elements in the news item from Dragon TV

Starting and ending time	Presentational element	Time length	Percentage of total time (174'')
00:00-00:19	(News kernel) studio-based on-camera address	19''	15.70%
00:19-01:14	(News subsidiary) studio-based voice-over (with sound-bite in the background)	55 ''	45.45%
01:14-01:32	(News subsidiary) field-based sound-bite	18''	14.88%
01:32-01:39	(News subsidiary) studio-based voice-over	7''	5.79%
01:39-02:01	(News subsidiary) field-based sound-bite	22''	18.18%

Table 3. Percentage of the total time on different presentational forms for both news items. (Note: the opening music visual sign-in (5'') in SET iNews is omitted in the table)

	Field-based sound byte	Studio-based voiceover	Sign-off	Studio-based on-camera address
SET iNews	27.00%	65.00%	2.00%	0.00%
Dragon TV	33.06%	51.24%	0.00%	16.70%

In the news item provided by SET iNews, a news kernel, which is usually carried out in studio-based forms, is absent and is rather displaced by a field-based sound-bite with the headline appearing in the footage at the bottom, yet it includes a studio-based sign-off at the end that consists of the news institution (SET iNews) and the reporter’s name. The fact that SET iNews excludes a news kernel is considered to be not aligned with Montgomery’s arguments about the essential role of news kernels in broadcast news (Montgomery 2007, 83). An alternative explanation would be that a news kernel has already been presented in the news program ahead of the video instead of within it. Further research is required to examine if this is really the case.

In contrast, the news item from Dragon Television includes a news kernel with a studio-based on-camera address that lasts for 19 seconds and is delivered by the news anchor. By looking directly into the camera, the presenter utilizes eye gaze and the mode of face-to-face communication to request the audience’s attention (Kendon 1967). However, the news item lacks a studio-based sign-off, which is considered by Montgomery (2007, 104) to be the reporter’s practice of “identifying him or herself by name and situating him or herself in the space of the broadcast.” Sign-offs help endorse the “overlapping and complementary refer-

ences between the verbal and visual imageries” (Montgomery 2007, 105). As sign-off phrases are used to “provide detection cues for the end of a broadcast,” this news item may be in the middle of the news program (Merlino et al. 1997).

Even though the length of the news item from SET iNews is shorter, it has more transitions between presentational forms ($n=11$), which alternate more frequently with one another, with the duration of each presentational form distributed relatively evenly ($M=8.55''$, $SD=5.98$). On the other hand, the news subsidiary presented by Dragon Television has fewer transitions between presentational forms ($n=5$), which alternate less frequently with one another and have more varied durations ($M=24.20''$, $SD=16.22$), with one studio-based voice-over especially long and accounting for nearly half of the news item.

Comparative analysis of the percentage of the total time for different types of presentational forms demonstrates that, for both news items, studio-based voice-overs (SET iNews: 60.00%. Dragon TV: 51.24%) and field-based sound-bites (SET iNews: 27.00%. Dragon TV: 33.06%) constitute the majority, with the former longer than the latter. The total duration of field-based sound-bites in SET iNews is slightly shorter, while the total duration of studio-based voice-overs in Dragon TV is slightly shorter.

3.3 Analysis of voice presentations and sourcing patterns

According to Feng (2016), television news is “multi-voiced,” with a “hybridized discourse” that consists of voices from different perspectives and sources. In the following analysis, we primarily focus on non-journalistic voices in the quoted sources, which are usually delivered by non-journalistic participants that do not represent the news institution (e.g., a witness, a public figure, an expert, or related personnel). The sources can be presented either in a direct or an indirect mode. In a direct mode, the words are kept in their initial forms without any paraphrasing. This is usually realized by directly “inserting an interview fragment or a video-based sound-bite into the news report” (Feng 2016). However, in an indirect mode, the participant’s voice is “presented in a ‘refracted,’ indirect fashion through a news presenter’s on-camera address or voice-over” (Feng 2016).

The selection and arrangement of the news sources play important roles in channeling the direction of narrative construction and thus the audience’s interpretation of the reported event. Previous studies (Cann and Mohr 2001, Jha and Izard 2005, Ross 2007, Desmond and Danilewicz 2010) focusing on sourcing patterns of journalists have found a preference for male sources over female sources. Similarly, “power and expertise” are favored over “ordinary people” as sources for most news makers, with private broadcasters having a higher percentage of sources from ordinary people (De Swert and Kuypers 2020). Additionally, a racial

hierarchy has been demonstrated to exist in news sources in that White Americans account for the majority of news sources. Even within ethnic news, racial minorities are also less likely to be quoted (Van Dijk 2000). On the other hand, racial minorities would compete for the rest of the news sources’ presentations in a dynamic ordering of the sourcing pattern, “depending upon social, political, and cultural contexts” (Domke et al. 2003, Entman and Rojecki 2000, Gray 1987, Shah and Thornton 1994, Gandy 1998). Therefore, in the following analysis, we will examine the types of sources selected for the two news items in the above aspects and discuss their implications with regards to the properties of the news providers and the social context of the reported event.

Table 4. Types and Presentational Modes of sources in SET iNews

Sources	Presentational			
	mode	Voice type	Gender	Race
(1) A witness’s voice	Direct	Ordinary people	Male	African American
(2) Donald Trump’s voice on behalf of the federal government	Direct	Public figure (governmental)	Male	White

Table 5. Types and Presentational Modes of sources in Dragon TV

Sources	Presentational			
	mode	Voice type	Gender	Race
(1) LeBron James’s voice	Direct	Public figure	Male	African American
(2) Martin Luther King III’s voice	Direct	Public figure	Male	African American
(3) Jesse Jackson	Direct	Public figure	Male	African American
(4) Benjamin Crump, George Floyd’s lawyer	Direct	Public figure	Male	African American

Analysis of the sourcing patterns for both new items, as presented in Tables 4 and 5, reveals that all sources are presented in the direct mode. While both voices from the authority and ordinary people are present in the news item from SET iNews, Dragon TV only includes voices from public figures as opinion leaders. This pattern could be attributed to that SET iNews, as a private broadcaster, may have a greater tendency than Dragon TV, a provincial satellite TV station, to

include ordinary people as news sources (De Swert and Kuypers 2020). While Dragon TV includes only public figures as news sources to increase the credibility of its news content, SET iNews includes “ordinary citizens [as news sources to] add vividness to a [the] newscast, which could be a crucial element attracting a larger audience” (Hendriks Vettehen, Nuijten, and Beentjes 2005).

Additionally, the majority of the sources are African American, in contrast to the aforementioned White-dominating racial hierarchy in news sources, this is likely due to the fact that these news items specifically revolve around policing practices towards an African American man and a general social consensus in the attitude towards the incident has been reached. However, all of the presented African American voices are “limited to individual opinions,” and such a shortage in coverage of African Americans as governmental leaders, as Domke et al. (2003) point out, might be due to “their relative dearth in these positions.” Lastly, it is also worth noting that, though the news presenters are both female in the two news items, no female sources are present in any form, which complies with the fact that women are largely underrepresented as sources in news coverage in different levels of news organizations. Such patterns have been extensively observed in news media from other parts of the world, especially in the US.

3.4 Headline and sub-headline analysis

A definitive feature of a news report is the headlines or lead, which highly represents the essence of the upcoming news item and would in some way orient the audience to perceive and process the presented news item in a certain direction (Teo 2000, Konnikova 2014). Revolving around the headlines of the selected news clips, discourse analysis from the micro-level is conducted with regards to the lexical and syntactic manipulations from both media and their social implications concerning the relationships between the media, government, and audience. The following examples are glossed in accordance with the Leipzig Glossing rules (Bickel, Comrie, and Haspelmath 2008) to facilitate analysis of the headlines from SET iNews and Dragon TV, respectively. Leipzig Glossing rules have been extensively used by linguists as a standard to analyze the syntax and semantics of texts.

- (1) 美国又爆种族歧视!? 黑人男子因警察执法过当丧命!! 黑人上街抗议爆发
警民冲突!!!
美国又爆种族歧视!?
Meiguo you bao zhongzu qishi!?
The US again explode race discrimination!?
‘The issue of racism explodes again in the US!?’

黑人男子因警察执法过当丧命!!

Hei ren nanzi yin jingcha zhi fa guo dang sang ming!!

Black man male because police execute law over appropriate lost life!!

‘A Black man lost his life due to police brutality!!’

黑人上街抗议爆发警民冲突!!!

Hei ren shang jie kangyi baofa jing min chongtu!!!

Black man take to street protest explode police citizen conflict!!!

‘Black people launch protests on the street, which triggers police-citizen conflicts!!!’

[From SET iNews]

The headline of the news item presented by SET iNews (1) specifically describes the progress of the killing of George Floyd and its associated social movements by explicitly pointing out the tension between the citizens and the police. It includes the major keywords related to these events, such as “racism,” “black men,” “police brutality,” “protest,” and “conflict,” which provide the audience with a straightforward interpretation of the news content. The headline also stresses the topic of racism by not only mentioning it but also by using the phrase “black men” twice. The headline also uses multiple exclamation marks (!! and !!!) combined with interrobang (!?) to put emphasis on the content and express a sense of excitement and disbelief. In this way, the headlines are made more attractive; whereas the formality, and thus the credibility of the news content, may be reduced simultaneously. Additionally, the headline describes the entire incident from a perspective in which the news provider is assertive about what really occurred. Such a practice, again, makes the constructed narrative stronger to the audience and reduces the space for doubt and disagreement.

(2) 美国警察涉嫌暴力执法致黑人死亡

Meiguo jingcha she xian baoli zhi fa zhi hei ren siwang

The US police involve suspect violence execute law lead to black man die

‘American police are suspected to cause a black man’s death with brutality.’

[From Dragon TV]

The headline Dragon TV provides (2) is shorter and focuses on the killing of George Floyd only. Though headlines (1) and (2) both address the relationship between police brutality and George Floyd’s death, headline (2) constructs the association in a way that is more implicit and objective in that the word “suspected” is used in order to stick to a factual statement that seems less opinionated by the news provider. Another nuance is that headline (1) uses “lost life” to indicate George Floyd’s death with the connotation that his life was coercively taken away by the police, directly attributing the blame to the police. Headline (2) simply uses “death” (died), though “brutality” is also used, to avoid potentially deviating from the facts. Given that the news item from Dragon TV was broadcasted

later than the one on SET iNews, and thus Dragon TV would have no less access to information about the killing of George Floyd, the juxtaposition of how the event is presented in these headlines suggests that Dragon TV is more conservative in its news report than SET iNews.

Such a difference, again, could be owing to the fact that media in Mainland China are under the control of the state agencies, “either through ownership or the power to regulate” (Tang and Iyengar 2011), and thus are systematically regulated to render the news report in an authoritative and objective manner. On the other hand, the journalistic freedom that Taiwanese society granted to its media, thanks to the media reforms, gave rise to a flexible yet competitive environment wherein media companies put commercial interests as a priority and keep making adjustments to attract the audience. Such practices may also expose the Taiwanese media system to “issues around professional ethics and the effects of sensationalism” (Rawnsley, Smyth, and Sullivan 2016).

Besides the headlines, which summarize the content of the entire news items, the sub-headlines, secondary headlines presented in the news subsidiaries, provide additional information to the headlines and are also worth examination (See Table 6).

Table 6. Sub-headlines from SET iNews and Dragon TV

Sub-headlines from SET iNews	Sub-headlines from Dragon TV
抗议美警执法过当 民众示威放火打劫 Citizens protested, set on fire, loot to dissent police brutality	“我无法呼吸” 悲剧再揭美种族歧视顽疾 “I can’t breathe” The tragedy reveals the chronic ill of racial discrimination in the US
群众上街要求正义 警方祭催泪弹反击 Citizens took to the street to plea for justice, and the police used tear shells to fight back	美国社会各界对警察暴力执法表示不满 People from all walks of life in the American society also expressed discontent with police brutality.
“我看了很难过” 川普下令FBI加快调查 “I was sad watching it” – Trump made an order to FBI to speed up the investigation	弗洛伊德家人聘请的律师：美种族歧视大流 行 The lawyer employed by the George Floyd’s families: the pandemic of racial discrimination in the US
群众示威变暴动 州长召国民兵控治安 Citizen protests turned into riots, and the state governor commanded the National Guard to maintain public security	

Sub-headlines, like headlines, play critical roles in shaping the audience's interpretation of the reported story, as they condense and summarize the news content and capture the audience's attention to the news. The comparison between the two news items showed that SET iNews tends to include sub-headlines that specifically describe the progress of the reported event and dramatize the conflicts between the citizens and the police. The statements regarding the authority were either neutral or positive, showing that the government is taking actions to conduct investigations or to address the conflicts. On the other hand, instead of specifically describing the event's progress, the sub-headlines from Dragon TV are broader and comment more on the event with criticism about the issue of racism in American society.

3.5 Lexical, syntactic choices and styles

Previous research has also found that word choice in news discourse plays an important role in shaping the audience's perception and interpretation of the reported events (Parenti 1986, Fairclough 1989, Nir and Roeh 1992). Linguistic choices may not exactly correspond to the social reality, but they may, in some manner, reflect the news provider's perspectives and serve as rhetorical devices for the reconstruction of reality (Fang 1994). Additionally, the use of dramatic language as a storytelling technique has been increasingly used in news production and "has been as much a part of news writing as chronicles" (Bird and Dardenne 1990). The rising popularity of this technique has led to criticism of suspected "sensationalism" that focuses more on the elicitation of "an emotional or sensual response" rather than on delivering factual information (Bird and Dardenne 1990). However, it has also been argued that information can be better retained if it is delivered in a storytelling way that "acknowledge[s] the demands of narrativity" so that the audience's attention is more focused (Bird and Dardenne 1990, Wang 2012).

In the news item presented by SET iNews, the discourse starts with the following descriptive voiceover that graphically depicts the visuals of the scene (See Figure 3).

- (3) 夜幕低垂, 眼前建筑烧得一片通红, 连汽车也陷入火海。
'As the night fell, the buildings in front of us were burning thoroughly red, and even the cars were caught in flames (the sea of fire).' [From SET iNews]

In this narration (3), the reporter uses descriptive phrases like "夜幕" [*ye mu*, the curtain of the night], "通红" [*tong hong*, thoroughly red] and "火海" [*huo hai*, sea of fire]. By doing so, the presenter aims to provide an evocative narrative that immediately draws the audience's attention. Such dramatic lexical choices,

beyond the information-providing scope of an objective news report, increase the vividness of the presentation, create more possibilities for the audience to put themselves into the scenarios, and, thus, elicit a stronger emotional response.

Additionally, throughout the discourse of the news subsidiary, specific scenes of police-citizen conflicts were described (4)–(5).

- (4) 纸板当盾牌，围巾当面罩，躲在大树后方求庇护。
'(They) use paper cards as shields, use scarves as masks, and hide behind the trees for protection.'
- (5) (群众将包围警车)，猛砸玻璃踢板筋。
'The citizens even surround the patrol wagon, fiercely smashing the glass and kicking the plates.'

[From SET iNews]

Again, such detailed descriptions of the occurrence, together with provocative imagery of the conflicts, reflect the facet of sensational storytelling in journalism, which renders the news interesting for the audience but may conflict with journalism's role as a provider of fact (Hallin 1986). SET iNews, as a newsmaker in Taiwan, operates in a commercial broadcasting system in which deregulation results in competition amongst news providers, which then drives sensationalization of news presentations in the pursuit of higher audience ratings and commercial benefits. As journalists realize that storytelling overshadows fact-telling in gratifying the audience, more attention is paid to the dramatization of news presentation, especially when similar news items have been reported previously or are also being reported by other news media. The deficiency in strict political controls and journalistic regulations also allows for more freedom in exploring the boundaries between journalism and other types of communicators that occupy the domain of media (Carlson and Lewis 2015, Boesman and Costera Meijer 2018). In comparison, the report by Dragon TV mainly adheres to the traditional way of news broadcasting in terms of fact-telling, largely lacking the detailed depictions described above.

News media in mainland China have experienced a certain level of liberalization during the era of economic reform, though governmental regulations are still maintained to a certain degree (Cooper-Chen and Scotton 2010). Such a media environment can be reflected in the fact that, besides leaning towards sourcing mainly from public figures, Dragon TV presents the events from the spectator's perspective with less dramatic language and fewer detailed descriptions of the conflicts. On the other hand, news media in Taiwan diverge from their counterparts in Mainland China in this aspect because of the competitive journalistic market and the lack of strict governmental and journalistic regulations.

3.6 Racial discourse analysis of lexical and syntactic choices

In the following section, lexical and syntactic analyses are conducted from a racial perspective with an interpretation of the presentation of racism and the racialization process in the news discourses. The analysis showed that, while differences are observed in the ways the news characters and the victim's death are addressed – with SET iNews tending to reduce news characters to their racial identities and utilize syntactic subjects for direct accusations and Dragon TV still remaining conservative in the accusation of agents – both media directly point out the issue of racism.

Firstly, disparities can be found in the manners the victim's death is described in the subsidiaries between the news items. In SET iNews, a strong causality was established between the violence and George Floyd's death, as shown in sentence (6) below. A clear depiction of brutality is presented by specifying that the police knelt on Floyd's neck, and a direct connection is made between that action and Floyd's suffocation. The sentence is in a transitive passive voice which directly identifies the police officers as the agent for the death, with the implication that the police should be responsible for the consequences. Additionally, the use of “遭”[zao] in the passive construction, according to Jing-Schmidt and Jing (2011), delivers the newsmaker's sympathy towards the victim while sensationalizing the news contents for a stronger emotional response.

- (6) 明尼苏达州非裔男子遭警察以膝盖压制脖子窒息丧命
'An African American male from Minnesota was knelt on the neck by the
police to suffocation and lost his life.' [From SET iNews]

For comparison, Dragon TV first mentions a different case of police brutality, the killing of Eric Garner in 2014. The intransitive verb “suffocated” is used to describe Garner's death, as shown in sentence (7). Compared to the transitive syntactic structure in sentence (6), this syntactic choice of mentioning only the victim (Eric Garner) and the event of his death, explicitly or implicitly, avoids addressing who might have caused the death (Fang 1994). Though a sequential order is presented with “death” occurring after “police still did not let go,” it remains ambiguous on the point of whether the police were the primary or direct cause of the death and should be held responsible. The report on George Floyd's death follows a similar pattern, in which the incident is nominalized as “the same tragedy,” without directly referring to the actual event, and the causal relationship between police brutality and the victim's death is implied rather than explicitly stated.

- (7) 但警察依旧没有松手，加纳窒息死亡 [...] 没想到六年后同样的悲剧再次上演。

‘But the police still did not let go, and Garner suffocated to death [...] unexpectedly the same tragedy struck again six years later.’ [From Dragon TV]

Differences in discourse strategies could also be observed in how the media address protesters and the police in the conflicts. SET iNews emphasizes both sides as agents for their actions by addressing them as syntactic subjects in the news script, indicating that both the protesters and police are responsible for the conflicts that happened. Such a syntactic choice by SET iNews suggests that the news maker shows a relatively unbiased standpoint when reporting on the police-citizen conflicts. However, a slight preference for the protester’s perspective could be speculated when the reporter implicitly blames the police for their responses to the protesters’ siege (8). Dragon TV simply mentions that social discontent exists because of police brutality (9) without further describing the associated citizen-police conflicts.

- (8) 没想到警方却没停车，还把人甩地后开车离开。

‘Unexpectedly, instead of stopping the car, the police threw the people off to the ground and drove away.’

- (9) 美国社会各界也对警察暴力执法感到不满。

‘People from all walks of life in American society also expressed discontent with police brutality.’ [From Dragon TV]

How Black individuals are referred to in the news items also reflects the media’s attitudes towards race as well as how the concept of race is constructed in the news discourses. George Floyd’s name is not mentioned in either the visual or the audio throughout the news item of SET iNews. Instead, his racial and geographic information is identified by addressing him as “明尼苏达州非裔男子,” “an African American man from Minnesota.” Such a practice of addressing a person without a name is identified by Entman (1992) as a discursive pattern with significance at the symbolic level, suggesting a tendency for homogenizing the victim with a larger group of racial minorities, deemphasizing their individuality, and thus potentially reinforcing the stereotypes about the population (frequently involved in fights against the police in the case of the study). The protesters were also explicitly addressed by their racial identities as “非裔,” ethnically African (American) and “白人,” White people. Such identification of the protesters may risk separating the two groups lexically. Generally, SET iNews tends to not identify the people covered in the news item by name but, instead, by racial identity. Besides elevating the likelihood for stereotype reinforcement about the involved

social groups, this lexical choice might also potentially dramatize the narratives by over-emphasizing and juxtaposing the identities.

On the other hand, though addressing the victim by his racial identity multiple times, including in the headline, Dragon TV also addresses the victim by his name in the news item (10). In an earlier similar case, the death of Eric Garner in 2014, Eric's name was also directly addressed (11). Instead of “遭” [zao], as is observed in (6), “被” [bei] is used in the passive construction of (11) to objectively recognize the treatments that the victim received without connotations for sensationalizing the news content, as it have been used in a wide spectrum of affective discursive contexts (Jing-Schmidt and Jing 2011).

- (10) 弗洛伊德家人聘请的律师：美种族歧视大流行
'The lawyer employed by George Floyd's family: the proliferation of racial discrimination in the US'
- (11) 黑人烟贩加纳因涉嫌非法售烟被美国警察摁倒在地逮捕 [...] 但警察依旧没有松手，加纳窒息死亡。
'A black cigarette dealer, Garner, was pulled to the ground and arrested by American police due to suspected illegal cigarette selling [...] But the police still did not let go, and Garner suffocated to death.' [From Dragon TV]

Neither of the two news items avoid explicating the issue of racism in the reports. These reports are, in a certain degree, inconsistent with what Entman (1992) and Van Dijk (1992, 2000) observe as the subtle modern racism deviating from the traditional explicit racism and white supremacy. Van Dijk (1992) mentions that the concept of 'racism' has gradually been intentionally avoided, distanced, or substituted with other terms, such as 'prejudice' and 'racial motivation', in western public discourses, such as the media. However, in the two Chinese media analyzed in this study, the notion of racism is directly pointed out in the news reports. SET iNews directly mentions "racism" in the headline and sentence (12) in the news subsidiary, recognizing it as a social issue that needs to be solved.

- (12) 种族歧视争议短时间内恐怕难以平息。
'Unfortunately, the controversy of racism is difficult to settle in a short time.'
[From SET iNews]

Additionally, Dragon TV includes journalistic and non-journalistic comments that relate the reported events to a larger social context and describe the death of George Floyd as a reflection of racism (13)–(14). Besides commenting on police brutality negatively, the news item from Dragon TV connects the killing of George Floyd to a broader social and historical background by explicitly pointing out that racial discrimination and anti-Black sentiment are deep-seated issues in the US.

- (13) ... 以抗议警方暴力执法, 抗议种族歧视在美国根深蒂固。
 ‘... to protest the police brutality and to protest the issue of racial discrimination ingrained in American society.’
- (14) ... 弗洛伊德家人聘请的律师认为, 他的死反映出种族歧视在美国根深蒂固。
 ‘... The lawyer employed by George Floyd’s family thought that his death reflected that racial discrimination is ingrained in the United States.’
- [From Dragon TV]

In the state-controlled system, media in Mainland China are under governmental supervision and operate on the basis of “[promoting] and [supporting] regimes as national instruments” (Wang 2012). Therefore, Dragon TV’s comments may also be seen to imply a negative social sentiment in Mainland China that could be the result of the deteriorating China-US relations brought about by the two countries’ mutual finger-pointing regarding guilt for the global COVID-19 pandemic (Okeeffe et al. 2020), the trade war, and the PRC’s policies towards Hong Kong (Wong et al. 2020).

4. Discussion and conclusion

The present study identified differences in presentational forms, sourcing patterns, headlines and sub-headlines, lexical and syntactic choices, as well as the racial discourses between the two news items from Dragon TV in Mainland China and SET iNews in Taiwan.

The analysis of presentational forms demonstrated that SET iNews excludes a news kernel but includes a voice-over sign-off, while Dragon TV does the opposite. Additionally, the presentational forms in SET iNews alternate more frequently with one another, with the duration of each distributed relatively evenly, while Dragon TV has fewer transitions between presentational forms with more varied durations. This juxtaposition is similar to the one demonstrated by Feng (2016) in which he contrasts samples from BBC News at Ten and CCTV. He argues that BBC News, with more diversified presentational forms, presents a “a type of multi-voiced discourse” that is more natural and credible, while CCTV has fewer presentational forms and distributes the majority of time to studio-based presentation “as if orienting to a single institutional authoritative voice” (Feng 2016). Though SET iNews does not necessarily have more presentational forms than Dragon TV, it presents more alterations between the forms in a way that different types of voices are coexistent and intertwined. This provides the audience with a more eclectic news presentation while attracting the audience’s

attention simultaneously. With regards to the discussion about racial discourse, SET iNews may also hold advantages in convincing the audience of the issue of racism by providing the news report with multiple presentational forms in an interleaved fashion.

A comparison of the sources used in the news items showed that, while voices from authority figures and ordinary people coexist in SET iNews, Dragon TV has sources only from public figures. Such a distinction, according to De Swert and Kuypers (2020), might be due to a hybrid of factors, including but not limited to the types of the news providers, commercial factors, national factors, and journalistic cultures. While an extensive analysis of how these factors influence the sourcing pattern is beyond the scope of the study, it is reasonable to propose that SET iNews, as a privately run news channel, would be more commercially driven than Dragon TV, a provincial satellite TV station, and would thus tend to include ordinary people as news sources to add vividness to the news and attract a larger audience. Additionally, the journalistic culture in Taiwan encourages the media to cling to the tenet of civic journalism, which aims to promote civic engagement in public discussions, through involving ordinary people as news sources (Ahva 2013). Whereas the media in China, under various degrees of governmental regulation, try to convey authoritative messages only. As a result, while SET iNews lacks sufficient authoritative sources, which would otherwise increase the credibility of its report, it utilizes sources of ordinary people to achieve a balance between elite voices and civic discussions to better approach and convince the audience of the news events and its associated issue of racism. While SET iNews demonstrated a racial balance in news sources, the majority of the sources in Dragon TV are African American. The phenomenon is likely due to the fact that the news report revolves around the policing practices towards George Floyd, an African American man, and thus the white-dominating racial hierarchy in news sources is reversed. Female sources are absent in both news items, complying with previous research findings on the preference for male news sources.

Analysis of the headlines (sub-headlines) showed that the headline of SET iNews specifies the progression of the events and directly points out the issues of “racism” and “police-citizen conflict.” Within the headline, a direct causal relationship is drawn between the police brutality and George Floyd’s “losing life.” Together, the headline and sub-headlines dramatize the conflicts between the police and the citizens by describing a series of confrontations between the two sides and attribute the blame more to the police. On the other hand, the headline of Dragon TV constructs the relationship between police brutality and the victim’s death more implicitly by using the word “suspected” and simply using “death,” rather than “lost life,” to describe George Floyd’s death. Instead of describing the conflicts and explicitly blaming the police for brutality, the sub-headlines

in Dragon TV repetitively reflect on the ingrained social issue of racial discrimination in American society. Such a tendency may be explained by Dragon TV's avoidance of giving voice to civil unrest, as supporting protests in other countries may imply encouragements for civil unrest in China, which has long been stigmatized and suppressed in the Chinese context. Therefore, a near paradox could be observed in the way Dragon TV navigates its stance to attribute the blame to the US government without sympathizing with the protesters.

Analysis of the lexical and syntactic choices as well as the styles showed that Dragon TV tends to stick to objective statements with less sensational language. Meanwhile, Dragon TV also tends to use institutional journalistic comments in the studio-based voice-over to elevate the social significance of George Floyd's death as emblematic of the issue of racism in the US. On the other hand, SET iNews tends to use dramatic language as a form of storytelling to add vividness to the news content and draw the audience's attention. However, such a practice of news presentation may also risk reducing the credibility and authority of the news. The disparities in phrasing and presentational style between the two media are largely entailed by the heterogeneities in the media systems and market environments between Mainland China and Taiwan. Taiwanese media, provided with a greater extent of journalistic freedom and financial independence, tend to lean towards the storytelling side of journalism to attract a larger audience and survive among other competitors. While the present study focuses on racism news coverage, the above differences in news reporting could also be observed across other news topics. For instance, Chiang and Duann (2007) found that, in terms of the naming of the SARS virus, Taiwanese media coined the term *sha* to demonize the disease and thus to engage the audience through storytelling, yet Chinese media tended to use trivializing terms to obscure the seriousness of the virus. Future investigations are needed on other topics of news report to support this argument. Further analysis of the lexical and syntactic choices from a racial perspective showed that SET iNews and Dragon TV differ in the manners of addressing news characters, with the former referring to individuals by their racial identities alone, which may risk enhancing racial stereotypes. Additionally, SET iNews's syntactic choices in describing the citizen-police conflicts imply that both sides are responsible. However, the protester's perspective is preferred, as is observed in the attribution of blame to the police.

In general, it is reasonable to hypothesize that, as media operations in Taiwan are largely commercially driven, their news coverage tends to utilize diversities in presentational forms, dramatic language for storytelling, and news sourcing of ordinary people to increase the vividness of the news items. The attempts to attract viewers could also be seen in the tendency to present the racial identities of news subjects for viewer consumption, as observed in the present study. On

the other hand, media in Mainland China are highly regulated by the government and thus, to various degrees, represent the governmental voice. This phenomenon could be further supported by the tendency to use public figures as sources, to be conservative in agent accusation, and to relate the reported incident to the issues of ingrained racism in American society, as observed in the present study. The negative attitudes towards the US among media in Mainland China also reflect the deteriorating Sino-American relationship.

Despite these differences, both media explicitly identify the issue of racism in American society. This finding differs from the previous ones on Western media, which deviates from the logic of “colorblind racism.” Consequently, the discrepancies in news presentation between the two media divergently shape the perceptions of their respective audience towards the reported events and the issue of racism in the US. While audiences from both Chinese communities may be able to identify racism as a pressing social issue to be addressed, those of SET iNews may attribute the guilt more to the police for their brutality and their repression of the protests while seeing the police-citizen conflicts as the major cause of the whole series of events. On the other hand, Dragon TV’s report tends to blur the boundaries between the two sides, leading to the perception that, while racism prevails in American society, the police’s roles should be evaluated more objectively by considering the citizens’ roles simultaneously. Additionally, Dragon TV links George Floyd’s death to the issue of racism in American society and attributes the blame to the US government, whereas SET iNews portrays the US government’s active role in resolving the issues. This difference may also result in a bifurcation in the perception of government’s agency in that the audience of Dragon TV may see the US government as the origin of the involved issue of racism and that of SET iNews may see the government as the problem solver. Negative depictions of American society have been seen in the media in Mainland China for years (Chang, Wang, and Chen 1994), and such a pattern could be further augmented by the deterioration of the Sino-American relationship due to the mutual accusations and disagreements concerning the guilt for the spread of COVID-19, the trade war, and the Chinese government’s policies in Hong Kong and other areas.

The present study contributes to the field of critical discourse analysis by using the framework to study the news broadcasting in Chinese media with respect to the journalistic environments and governmental regulations in Mainland China and Taiwan. Additionally, it analyzes the news discourses from a racial perspective to provide an understanding of how racism is constructed and potentially reproduced in Chinese media. However, only two news clips are included as samples, with both reporting on the killing of George Floyd and its associated social movements. Consequently, it remains ambiguous whether the differences

found between the two news clips could be applied to news broadcasting on other topics, from other time periods, or by other news providers. Future research may need to include larger sample sizes with longitudinal comparisons across news items to get more consistent results and confirm the findings of the present study. To achieve a deeper insight into how the media systems and journalistic markets in Mainland China and Taiwan affect news presentation in general, it is important to also include a cluster analysis that compares multiple mainstream media in both areas.

Acknowledgements

The author would like to thank Liz Carter for her mentorship throughout the process of writing this manuscript and for her valuable advice on various aspects of the analysis. The author would also like to thank Xi Xu, Elizabeth Sola-Llonch, and Yaying Bai for their suggestions in revising the paper, and Zhuo Jing-Schmidt and the anonymous reviewers of *Chinese Language and Discourse* for their constructive and helpful feedback.

References

- Ahva, Laura. 2013. "Public journalism and professional reflexivity." *Journalism* 14 (6): 790–806. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1464884912455895>
- Alim, H. Samy, Angela Reyes, and Paul V. Kroskrity (eds). 2020. *The Oxford handbook of language and race*. Oxford University Press. <https://doi.org/10.1093/oxfordhb/9780190845995.001.0001>
- Archetti, Cristina. 2010. "Comparing international coverage of 9/11: Towards an interdisciplinary explanation of the construction of news." *Journalism* 11 (5): 567–588. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1464884910373536>
- Barker, Martin. 1981. *The new racism: Conservatives and the ideology of the tribe*. Junction Books.
- Bednarek, Monika, and Helen Caple. 2014. "Why do news values matter? Towards a new methodological framework for analyzing news discourse in Critical Discourse Analysis and beyond." *Discourse & Society* 25 (2): 135–158. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0957926513516041>
- Bell, Allan. 1991. *The language of news media*. Oxford: Blackwell.
- Bird, S. Elizabeth, and Robert W. Dardenne. 1990. "News and storytelling in American culture: Reevaluating the sensational dimension." *The Journal of American Culture* 13 (2): 33–37. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1542-734X.1990.1302_33.x
- Boesman, Jan, and Irene Costera Meijer. 2018. "'Don't Read me the News, Tell me the Story': How News Makers and Storytellers Negotiate Journalism's Boundaries When Preparing and Presenting News Stories." *ISOJ: The Official Research Journal of the International Symposium on Online Journalism* 8 (1): 13–32.
- Bonilla-Silva, Eduardo. 2006. *Racism without racists: Color-blind racism and the persistence of racial inequality in the United States*. Rowman & Littlefield Publishers.

- Cann, David J., and Philip B. Mohr. 2001. "Journalist and source gender in Australian television news." *Journal of Broadcasting & electronic media* 45 (1): 162–174.
https://doi.org/10.1207/s15506878jobem4501_10
- Carlson, Matt, and Seth C. Lewis (eds). 2015. *Boundaries of journalism: Professionalism, practices and participation*. New York, NY: Routledge.
- Chandler, Daniel. 2007. *Semiotics: The basics* (2nd ed.). Abingdon, UK: Routledge.
<https://doi.org/10.4324/9780203014936>
- Chang, Tsan-Kuo, Jian Wang, and Chih-Hsien Chen. 1994. "News as social knowledge in China: The changing worldview of Chinese national media." *Journal of Communication* 44 (3): 52–69. <https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1460-2466.1994.tb00688.x>
- Cheng, Yinghong. 2011. "From Campus Racism to Cyber Racism: Discourse of Race and Chinese Nationalism." *The China Quarterly* 207: 561–579.
<https://doi.org/10.1017/S0305741011000658>
- Chiang, Chun-Fang, and Hsiu-Han Shih. 2017. "Consumer Preferences regarding News Slant and Accuracy in News Programs." *Jing Ji Lun Wen Cong Kan* 45 (4), 515–545.
- Chiang, Wen-Yu, and Ren-Feng Duann. 2007. "Conceptual metaphors for SARS: 'war' between whom?." *Discourse & society* 18 (5): 579–602.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/0957926507079631>
- Cooper-Chen, Anne, and James F. Scotton. 2010. "Television: News." *New Media For A New China*: 98–114.
- Bickel, Balthasar, Bernard Comrie, and Martin Haspelmath. 2008. "The Leipzig Glossing Rules: Conventions for interlinear morpheme-by-morpheme glosses." *Department of Linguistics of the Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology and the Department of Linguistics of the University of Leipzig*.
- Desmond, Roger, and Anna Danilewicz. 2010. "Women are on, but not in, the news: Gender roles in local television news." *Sex Roles* 62 (11): 822–829.
<https://doi.org/10.1007/s11199-009-9686-5>
- De Swert, Knut, and Ine Kuypers. 2020. "Ordinary People Regularly Reported? Looking for Patterns in the Presence of Ordinary Citizens in Television News in 20 European Countries." *Journalism Studies* 21 (8): 1037–1054.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/1461670X.2020.1745664>
- Domke, David, Philip Garland, Andre Billeaudeau, and John Hutcheson. 2003. "Insights into US racial hierarchy: Racial profiling, news sources, and September 11." *Journal of Communication* 53 (4): 606–623. <https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1460-2466.2003.tb02913.x>
- Eberl, Jakob-Moritz, Christine E. Meltzer, Tobias Heidenreich, Beatrice Herrero, Nora Theorin, Fabienne Lind, Rosa Berganza, Hajo G. Boomgaarden, Christian Schemer, and Jesper Strömbäck. 2018. "The European media discourse on immigration and its effects: A literature review." *Annals of the International Communication Association* 42, no. 3: 207–223. <https://doi.org/10.1080/23808985.2018.1497452>
- Entman, Robert M. 1992. *Blacks in the news: Television, modern racism and cultural change*. *Journalism quarterly* 69 (2): 341–361.
- Entman, Robert M., and Andrew Rojecki. 2000. *The black image in the white mind: Media and race in America*, Chicago: University of Chicago Press.
- Fairclough, Norman. 1989. *Language and Power*. London: Longman.
- Fairclough, Norman. 1992. *Discourse and social change*. Cambridge: Polity press.
- Fairclough, Norman. 1995. *Critical Discourse Analysis*. London: Longman.

- Fang, Yew-Jin. 1994. "Riots' and demonstrations in the Chinese press: a case study of language and ideology." *Discourse & Society* 5 (4): 463–481.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/0957926594005004003>
- Fang, Yew-Jin. 2001. "Reporting the same events? A critical analysis of Chinese print news media texts." *Discourse & Society* 12 (5): 585–613.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/0957926501012005002>
- Feng, Debing. 2013. "National voice: A discourse analysis of China central television's news simulcast." *Discourse & Communication* 7 (3): 255–273.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/1750481313487619>
- Feng, Debing. 2016. "Doing "authentic" news: Voices, forms, and strategies in presenting television news." *International Journal of Communication* 10: 19.
- Fowler, Roger. 1991. *Language in the News: Discourse and Ideology in the British Press*. London: Routledge.
- Fowler, Roger, Bob Hodge, Gunther Kress, and Tony Trew. 1979. *Language and Control*. London: Routledge and Kegan Paul. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9780429436215>
- Gandy, Oscar H. 1998. *Communication and race: A structural perspective*. London: Arnold.
- Gray, Herman. 1987. "Race relations as news." *American Behavioral Scientist* 30: 381–396.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/000276487030004004>
- Liu, Ke, and Fang Guo. 2016. "A Review on Critical Discourse Analysis." *Theory and Practice in Language Studies* 6 (5): 1076–1084. <https://doi.org/10.17507/tpls.0605.23>
- Hallin, Daniel C. 1986. *The uncensored war: The media and Vietnam*. Oxford, UK: Oxford University Press.
- Hendriks Vettehen, Paul, Koos Nuijten, and Johannes Beentjes. 2005. "News in an age of competition: The case of sensationalism in Dutch television news, 1995–2001." *Journal of Broadcasting & Electronic Media* 49 (3): 282–295.
https://doi.org/10.1207/s15506878jobem4903_2
- Jha, Sonora, and Ralph Izard. 2005. "Who got to talk about it: Sourcing and attribution in broadcast news coverage of the first 24 hours of the 9/11 tragedy." *Seattle Journal for Social Justice* 4 (1): 101–118.
- Jing-Schmidt, Zhuo and Ting Jing. 2011. "Embodied semantics and pragmatics: Empathy, sympathy and two passive constructions in Chinese media discourse." *Journal of Pragmatics* 43: 2826–2844. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.pragma.2011.04.005>
- Kendon, Adam. 1967. "Some functions of gaze-direction in social interaction." *Acta psychologica* 26: 22–63. [https://doi.org/10.1016/0001-6918\(67\)90005-4](https://doi.org/10.1016/0001-6918(67)90005-4)
- Kim, Kyung Hye. 2014. "Examining US news media discourses about North Korea: A corpus-based critical discourse analysis." *Discourse & Society* 25 (2): 221–244.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/0957926513516043>
- Konnikova, Maria. 2014. "How Headlines Change the Way We Think." *The New Yorker*. Accessed September 11, 2020. <https://www.newyorker.com/science/maria-konnikova/headlines-change-way-think>
- Kress, Gunther, and Robert Hodge. 1979. *Language as Ideology*. London: Routledge & Kegan Paul.
- Merlino, Andrew, Daryl Morey, and Mark Maybury. 1997. "Broadcast news navigation using story segmentation." In *Proceedings of the fifth ACM international conference on Multimedia*: 381–391. <https://doi.org/10.1145/266180.266390>
- Montgomery, Martin. 2007. *The discourse of broadcast news: A linguistic approach*. Routledge. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9780203006634>

- Nir, Raphael and Itzhak Roeh. 1992. "Intifada Coverage in the Israeli Press: Popular and Quality Papers Assume a Rhetoric of Conformity." *Discourse & Society* 3 (1): 47–60. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0957926592003001003>
- O'Keefe, Kate, Michael C. Bender, and Chun Han Wong. 2020. "Coronavirus Casts Deep Chill Over US-China Relations." *Wall Street Journal*. Accessed October 12, 2020. <https://www.wsj.com/articles/coronavirus-casts-deep-chill-over-u-s-china-relations-11588781420>
- Oriola, Temitope B., and W. Andy Knight. 2020. "COVID-19, George Floyd and Human Security." *African Security* 13 (2): 111–115. <https://doi.org/10.1080/19392206.2020.1783760>
- Pager, Devah, and Hana Shepherd. 2008. "The Sociology of Discrimination: Racial Discrimination in Employment, Housing, Credit, and Consumer Markets." *Annual review of sociology* 34: 181–209. <https://doi.org/10.1146/annurev.soc.33.040406.131740>
- Parenti, Michael. 1986. *Inventing Reality: The Politics of the Mass Media*. New York: St. Martin's Press.
- Rawnsley, Ming-yeh, James Smyth, and Jonathan Sullivan. 2016. "Taiwanese Media Reform." *Journal of the British Association for Chinese Studies* 6 (6): 66–80.
- Ross, Karen. 2007. "The journalist, the housewife, the citizen and the press: Women and men as sources in local news narratives." *Journalism* 8 (4): 449–473. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1464884907078659>
- Sarrina Li, Shu-Chu. 2001. "New media and market competition: A niche analysis of television news, electronic news, and newspaper news in Taiwan." *Journal of Broadcasting & Electronic Media* 45 (2): 259–276. https://doi.org/10.1207/s15506878jobem4502_4
- Shah, Hemant, and Michael C. Thornton. 1994. "Racial ideology in US mainstream news magazine coverage of Black-Latino interaction, 1980–1992." *Critical Studies in Media Communication* 11 (2): 141–161.
- Tang, Wenfang, and Shanto Iyengar. 2011. "The emerging media system in China: Implications for regime change." *Political Communication* 28 (3): 263–267. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10584609.2011.572446>
- Teo, Peter. 2000. "Racism in the news: A critical discourse analysis of news reporting in two Australian newspapers." *Discourse & society* 11 (1): 7–49. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0957926500011001002>
- Van Dijk, Teun. A. 1992. "Discourse and the denial of racism." *Discourse & society* 3 (1), 87–118. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0957926592003001005>
- Van Dijk, Teun. A. 1993. *Analyzing racism through discourse analysis: Some methodological reflections*. Sage Publications, Inc.
- Van Dijk, Teun. A. 1993. "Principles of critical discourse analysis." *Discourse & society* 4 (2): 249–283. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0957926593004002006>
- Van Dijk, Teun. A. 2000. "New (s) racism: A discourse analytical approach." *Ethnic minorities and the media* 37: 33–49.
- Winfield, Betty Houchin, and Zengjun Peng. 2005. "Market or Party Controls?: Chinese Media in Transition." *Gazette (Leiden, Netherlands)* 67 (3): 255–270. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0016549205052228>
- Wong, Chun Han and Natasha Khan. 2020. "China Votes to Override Hong Kong's Autonomy on National Security" *The Wall Street Journal*. Accessed August 29, 2020. <https://www.wsj.com/articles/chinas-legislature-approves-imposing-hong-kong-national-security-laws-11590653322>

- Wang, Tai-Li. 2012. "Presentation and impact of market-driven journalism on sensationalism in global TV news." *International Communication Gazette* 74 (8): 711–727.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/1748048512459143>
- Yin, Jing. 2006. "China's second long march: A review of Chinese media discourse on globalization." *The Review of Communication* 6 (1–2): 32–51.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/15358590600763268>

News sources

- 三立iNews. 2020. 美國又爆種族歧視!?黑人男子因警察執法過當喪命!!黑人上街抗議爆發警民衝突!!! [The issue of racism explodes again in the US!? A Black man lost his life due to police brutality!! Black people launch protests on the street, which triggers police-citizen conflicts!!!] Accessed July 10, 2020. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XB4apTQ1tNg>
- 看看新聞Knews綜合. 2020. 美国警察涉嫌暴力執法致黑人死亡. [American police are suspected to cause a black man's death with brutality.] Accessed July 12, 2020. <http://www.kankanews.com/a/2020-05-30/0019263524.shtml>

Address for correspondence

Chenyang Lin
 University of California at Los Angeles
 290 Royce Hall
 Los Angeles, CA 90095-1540
 USA
clin25@ucla.edu
 <https://orcid.org/0000-0002-6222-518X>

Publication history

Date received: 1 December 2020
 Date accepted: 22 July 2021
 Published online: 10 September 2021